

0.0.1 Strong City Gate Post

1. Indeed, O bhikkhus, those samanas or brahmanas who do not wisely understand as it has come to be: “This is suffering;” who do not wisely understand as it has come to be: “This is the origination of suffering;” who do not wisely understand as it has come to be: “This is the cessation of suffering;” who do not wisely understand as it has come to be: “This is the path leading to the cessation of suffering;” they look at the face of another samana or brahmana [thinking]: “Surely, this venerable one, knowing, he knows; seeing, he sees.” Just as, O bhikkhus, a light cotton wadding or cotton-wool, grasped by the wind, settles down on an even part of the ground. An easterly wind would carry it westwards, a westerly wind would carry it eastwards, a northerly wind would carry it southwards, a southerly wind would carry it northwards. What is the reason for that? O bhikkhus, [It is because of] the lightness of the cotton. It is just so, O bhikkhus, those samanas or brahmanas who do not wisely understand as it has come to be: “This is suffering;” who do not wisely understand as it has come to be: “This is the origination of suffering;” who do not wisely understand as it has come to be: “This is the cessation of suffering;” who do not wisely understand as it has come to be: “This is the way leading to the cessation of suffering;” they look at the face of another samana or brahmana [thinking]: “Surely, this venerable one, knowing, he knows; seeing, he sees.” What is the reason for that? O bhikkhus, [it is because of] their blindness to the four noble truths.

2. O bhikkhus, those samanas or brahmanas who wisely understand as it has come to be: “This is suffering;” who wisely understand as it has come to be: “This is the origination of suffering;” who wisely understand as it has come to be: “This is the cessation of suffering;” who wisely understand as it has come to be: “This is the path leading to the cessation of suffering;” they do not look at the face of another samana or brahmana [thinking]: “Surely, this venerable one, knowing, he knows; seeing, he sees.” Just as, O bhikkhus, an iron post or a strong post, deeply planted, well dug in before a city gate is immovable, unshakable. Even if heavy wind with rain might come from the eastern direction, that would simply not shake, would not tremble, would not sway. Even if heavy wind with rain might come from the western direction, that would simply not shake, would not tremble, would not sway. Even if heavy wind with rain might come from the northern direction, that would simply not shake, would not tremble, would not sway. Even if heavy wind with rain might come from the southern direction, that would simply not shake, would not tremble, would not sway. What is the reason for that? O bhikkhus, [it is because] of the depth of its base, the firm foundation of the strong city gate post. It is just so, O bhikkhus, those samanas or brahmanas who wisely understand as it has come to be: “This is suffering;” who wisely understand as it has come to be: “This is the origination of suffering;” who wisely understand as it has come to be: “This is the cessation of suffering;” who wisely understand as it has come to be: “This is the path

leading to the cessation of suffering;" they do not look at the face of another samana or brahmana [thinking]: "Surely, this venerable one, knowing, he knows; seeing, he sees." What is the reason for that? O bhikkhus, [it is because of] the well-seeing-ness of the four noble truths. Which four? The noble truth of suffering, the noble truth of the origination of suffering, the noble truth of the cessation of suffering, the noble truth of the path leading to the cessation of suffering.

3. Therefore, O bhikkhus, an endeavour should be made [to realize]: "This is suffering;" An endeavour should be made [to realize]: "This is the origination of suffering;" An endeavour should be made [to realize]: "This is the cessation of suffering;" An endeavour should be made [to realize]: "This is the path leading to the cessation of suffering;"